WaqfApp

Frequently Asked Questions

253 questions and answers across 24 sections
Covering payments, travel, Waqf and giving, the assistants, security and development

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About WaqfApp

What is WaqfApp?

WaqfApp is a digital wallet and philanthropy application built around the Islamic idea of Waqf, a charitable endowment whose benefit continues over time. In one place it brings together everyday money tasks (sending money, paying utility bills, topping up a mobile number, ordering food and booking travel) and tools that help you think about giving, saving and spending responsibly. The app shows your balances in Pakistani Rupees (PKR), offers a local Lahore marketplace of restaurants, hotels and flights, and can be used in English, Urdu or Arabic. It also includes a Money Helper that gives short suggestions about your spending, a Help Center assistant that answers questions about the app, and a Private Safe that demonstrates how sensitive notes can be kept encrypted.

Who is WaqfApp designed for?

WaqfApp is designed for individuals and families in Pakistan, particularly in Lahore, who want a single, simple place to manage day-to-day payments while keeping charitable giving close at hand. It is particularly suited to people in Lahore who order food, book hotels or plan Umrah and business travel from the city, to households that pay several utility bills each month, and to anyone who wants gentle guidance on budgeting. The interface uses plain language, large controls and a choice of three languages so that it can be used comfortably by people with different levels of experience with technology.

What does the name "Waqf" mean?

Waqf (plural awqaf) is an Arabic term for an endowment in Islamic law. A person sets aside an asset, such as land, a building, a well or a sum of money, so that its benefit is dedicated permanently to a charitable or religious purpose while the asset itself is preserved. Famous historical examples include endowed mosques, schools, hospitals and water fountains whose income or service continued for centuries. WaqfApp takes its name from this tradition: the goal is to make continuous, beneficial giving (Sadaqah Jariyah) feel like a natural part of everyday financial life.

Is WaqfApp a bank?

No. WaqfApp is not a bank and does not hold a banking licence. In its current form it is a demonstration application: the balance, transactions, bookings and loans you see are simulated so that you can explore how such a service would work. No real money moves when you press a button in the app. If WaqfApp is later connected to licensed payment partners, those partners would hold funds and process transactions under their own regulation, and the app would clearly tell you which partner is involved before you confirm any payment.

Is any real money involved when I use the app?

Not in the current version. Every action, whether a bill payment, a transfer, a mobile top-up, a hotel booking, a food order or a Quick Loan, creates a simulated transaction in the app's own in-memory ledger. Your displayed balance goes up or down accordingly so that you can see the effect of each action, but nothing is charged to a card, bank account or mobile wallet, and nothing is sent to a merchant. This makes the app safe to explore. Because the data is held in memory, it is also reset whenever the server restarts.

What can I do with WaqfApp?

From the home screen you can: see your total balance and a chart of how it has changed; read your recent payment history; send money to a mobile wallet or bank account; pay electricity, gas, water and internet bills; top up a mobile number on Jazz, Telenor, Zong or Ufone; add a manual entry to your ledger; take a small Quick Loan; browse hotels, flights and trip packages; order food from partner restaurants; collect travel items in your Waqf Portfolio; open the Private Safe; get a suggestion from the Money Helper; ask the Help Center assistant a question; leave a review; and change the language or colour theme.

Which countries and currencies does WaqfApp support?

All balances, prices and transactions in WaqfApp are shown in Pakistani Rupees (PKR). The marketplace is local to Lahore: five Lahore restaurants with full menus, five Lahore hotels, five flights from Lahore to Karachi, Quetta, Dubai, Jeddah and Istanbul, and trip deals for Umrah and Jeddah that start from Lahore. Fares for international flights are also shown in PKR so that you can compare them directly with your balance. The app does not currently perform currency conversion or hold balances in Saudi Riyals (SAR).

Which languages is WaqfApp available in?

WaqfApp is available in English, Urdu and Arabic. You can switch at any time using the EN, UR and AR buttons at the top of the dashboard. When you choose Urdu or Arabic, the layout switches to right-to-left so that text reads naturally. Menu labels, button names and the guidance texts change language immediately. Some content that comes from partners, such as hotel and restaurant names, stays in its original form.

Do I need to install anything to use WaqfApp?

No installation is needed to use WaqfApp as a customer. It is a web application that runs in a modern browser such as Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari, on a desktop computer, a laptop, a tablet or a phone. You simply open the address you have been given. If you are a developer who wants to run your own copy, you will need Node.js and the project's dependencies; the developer section of this FAQ explains how.

Is WaqfApp free to use?

Yes. The current demonstration version of WaqfApp is free to use and there are no subscription fees. Because no real money moves, there are also no transaction charges. The Quick Loan screen mentions that repayment terms apply; in this version that text is illustrative and no repayment is ever collected. If paid features or partner fees are introduced in future, they would be shown clearly before you confirm anything.

What makes WaqfApp different from other wallet apps?

Three things set WaqfApp apart. First, it is built around Islamic values: the home screen opens with the Bismillah, verses and hadith about continuous charity, and the app treats giving as a core feature rather than an afterthought. Second, it combines daily payments with a local Lahore marketplace for food, hotels and flights, including flights and packages for Umrah travellers. Third, it includes a built-in assistant that answers questions from this FAQ using a retrieval-based agent that runs on the app's own server, so it works without sending your questions to an external AI service.

Who develops and maintains WaqfApp?

WaqfApp is maintained by the WaqfApp Foundation project team. The source code is hosted on GitHub, where developers can review the code, report issues and suggest improvements. If you have a question that is not answered in this FAQ, use the Help Center assistant or leave a review through the Feedback button so the team can see it.

Your Account and Session

Do I need to register or log in to use WaqfApp?

No. The login and registration screens have been removed. When you open WaqfApp, the app automatically starts a session for you and takes you straight to the dashboard. There is no username or password to remember and no verification code to wait for. This makes the app quicker to try and removes the risk of reusing a password from another service.

Which account am I using when I open the app?

You are signed in to the shared demonstration account, which appears at the top of the dashboard as "Waqf Demo User" with the label "Level 2 Account". This account has a starting balance and a short history of sample transactions so that the dashboard has realistic content from the first moment. Everyone who opens the same copy of the app uses this same demonstration account, so you may see transactions that someone else created.

What happens when I press Log Out?

Pressing Log Out (the exit icon at the bottom of the left-hand sidebar) ends your current session and immediately starts a fresh one on the same demonstration account. You will see the dashboard reload. Logging out does not erase transactions you created during the session, because those are stored on the server rather than in your browser. They are cleared only when the server restarts.

How long does my session last?

Each session token is valid for 24 hours. The token is kept in your browser's local storage and sent with every request to the server so that the app knows which account the request belongs to. If the token expires, simply reload the page: the app starts a new session automatically. You will not be asked for any credentials.

Can I change my name, email or phone number?

Not in the current version. The demonstration account's name, email address and phone number are fixed. Profile editing is a natural feature for a future version that has personal accounts. For now, the "My Profile" area simply shows who you are signed in as.

Can I delete my account?

Yes, the app offers an option to permanently delete your account. You will be asked to confirm, because in a real service this action cannot be undone. In the demonstration version, deleting the account removes it from the server and starts a new session, and the app recreates a fresh demonstration account so that it can keep working. Transactions already recorded on the server are not removed by this action and disappear only when the server restarts.

Why can I see transactions I did not make?

Because the demonstration account is shared, any transaction created by anyone using the same copy of the app appears in the same history. For example, if a colleague paid a bill while testing, you will see that bill payment too. If you are running your own copy of WaqfApp on your own computer, only your own actions will appear, together with the sample transactions included at start-up.

Is two-factor authentication available?

Two-factor authentication belonged to the login flow, which has been removed along with the login and registration panels. Because there are no passwords and no personal accounts in the current version, there is nothing for a second factor to protect. If personal accounts are reintroduced, two-factor authentication would be an important feature to add back.

Can several people use WaqfApp at the same time?

Yes. Many people can open the app at once. Each person gets their own session token, but all sessions point at the same demonstration account, so everyone sees the same balance and transaction history and their actions affect each other's view. Refresh the page to see the latest state after someone else has made changes.

The Dashboard and Your Balance

What is shown on the home screen?

At the top you will see the Bismillah, the WaqfApp logo, and buttons for your Portfolio (cart), Feedback, theme, language and the QR scanner, together with your name. Below that are a Quranic verse and a hadith about continuous charity. The main area shows your Total Balance, the Money Flow Assistant (Money Helper), a row of Services buttons, a Money History Chart, and your Payment History. The left sidebar has shortcuts to Home, Travel, Order Food, your Payment history and the Help Center, with Log Out at the bottom, and the footer links to the Privacy Policy and the Help Center.

How is my total balance calculated?

Your total balance is your account's opening balance plus the sum of all transactions recorded against it. Money coming in, such as a Quick Loan disbursement or a positive manual entry, adds to the balance; payments such as bills, transfers, mobile top-ups, bookings and food orders subtract from it. The demonstration account starts with PKR 1,250,500 and includes a few sample transactions (for example a salary credit and a rent payment), which is why the balance you first see is lower than the opening amount.

What do the inflow and outflow figures under my balance mean?

Inflow is the total of all the money that has come in, such as your salary, Quick Loans and positive manual entries, and outflow is the total of all your payments, such as bills, transfers, bookings and food orders. Both are added up from the entries in your Payment History, so they always match it.

Why did my balance change even though I did nothing?

The demonstration account is shared, so another person using the same copy of the app may have made a payment or taken a loan. The server also resets to its starting state whenever it restarts, which can make the balance jump back to its original value. Check the Payment History to see which transactions are currently recorded.

What is the Money History Chart?

The Money History Chart shows how your balance has moved over recent months. The earlier points are sample figures for January, February and March, and the final point is your current balance, so the line updates immediately when you make a payment or receive money. Hover over or tap a point to see the exact value for that month.

What do the monthly income, expenses and savings rate figures mean?

These figures describe the demonstration profile: a monthly income of PKR 350,000 and monthly expenses of PKR 180,000, which leaves PKR 170,000 a month, a savings rate of 48.6 percent. Press Savings in the Services row to see this breakdown. Income and expenses are illustrative values for the profile and are not calculated from your transactions in the current version; the savings rate is always computed from them, so the figures agree. A credit score and an investment value are also included for the same purpose.

Where can I see my full transaction history?

Your recent transactions are listed in the Payment History section of the dashboard, newest first. Each entry shows the merchant or description (for example "KESC Bill - 9PKR-8822" or "Order from Butt Karahi (3 items)"), the category, when it happened (the time for today, "Yesterday", or the date before that) and the amount, with money going out shown with a minus sign. The section shows the six most recent entries; press "See all history" to show every entry and "Show less" to fold the list again. The Payment history icon in the sidebar jumps straight to it.

What do the transaction categories mean?

Each transaction has a category that describes what it was for. Categories you will see include Income, Housing, Shopping, Technology, Food & Drink, Food, Travel, Bills, Mobile Load, Transfer, Loan and General. Categories are assigned automatically when you use a service (for example, a bill payment is always "Bills") and can be chosen when you add a manual entry. They make it easier to see where your money goes and they are used by the Money Helper when it gives suggestions.

Can I edit or delete a transaction?

No. Transactions in WaqfApp cannot be edited or deleted once they are recorded, which mirrors how real financial ledgers work: a mistake is corrected with a new, opposite entry rather than by changing history. If you added an incorrect manual entry, add another manual entry for the opposite amount. In the demonstration version, all transactions are cleared when the server restarts.

Why are the amounts shown with decimals?

Amounts are shown to two decimal places, in line with how currency is normally displayed, even though Pakistani Rupee prices rarely include paisa in practice. Some sample transactions, such as a café purchase of PKR 4,500.50, deliberately include decimals to show that the ledger handles them correctly.

What is the QR scanner button for?

The square scanner icon near the top of the dashboard opens a QR payment screen. It shows a scanning frame with the message to align a QR code for payment. In the current version this is a preview of the feature: the camera is not activated and no payment is made. Press "Terminate Scanner" to close it.

The dashboard looks empty or will not load. What should I do?

The dashboard appears only after the app has started your session and loaded your balance. If the screen stays dark, wait a few seconds; the first load after the server starts can take longer while the app is prepared. Then reload the page. If it still does not appear, the server may not be running, or your browser may be blocking scripts. The Troubleshooting section of this FAQ has more detailed steps.

Sending Money

How do I send money to someone?

Press "Send Money" in the Services row on the dashboard. In the form that opens, enter the recipient's account or mobile number (for example 03450000000), choose where the money should go from the "Select Destination" list, type the amount in PKR, and press "Confirm Transfer". If every field is filled in and the amount is greater than zero, the transfer is recorded, the form closes, your balance goes down by the amount you sent, and a "Transfer to ..." entry appears at the top of your Payment History with the category "Transfer".

Where can I send money to?

The Send Money form offers three destinations: JazzCash, Easypaisa and Bank Account (IBFT). JazzCash and Easypaisa are popular mobile wallets in Pakistan, so for these you would normally enter the recipient's mobile wallet number. IBFT (Inter Bank Funds Transfer) is the system Pakistani banks use to move money between accounts at different banks, so for this option you would normally enter the recipient's account number or IBAN. The destination you choose is shown in brackets next to the recipient in your Payment History.

What format should the recipient number be in?

For JazzCash and Easypaisa, use the recipient's 11-digit mobile number starting with 03, for example 03001234567, without spaces or dashes. For bank transfers, use the full account number or the 24-character IBAN that starts with PK. In the current demonstration version the app accepts any non-empty value, so it is up to you to type it carefully. In a live service the number would be checked against the provider before the transfer is accepted, and you would see the account holder's name to confirm.

Is there a minimum or maximum amount I can send?

The amount must be greater than zero; the form will not accept an empty, zero or negative amount and will show the message "Please fill in every field with a valid amount". There is no upper limit in the demonstration version, and the app does not stop you from sending more than your balance, so your balance can become negative. A live service would apply daily and monthly limits set by the payment provider and by regulation, and would refuse a transfer that exceeds your available balance.

How long does a transfer take?

In the demonstration version a transfer is recorded instantly: as soon as you press "Confirm Transfer" your balance and history update. With real providers, transfers to JazzCash and Easypaisa and IBFT transfers between Pakistani banks are usually completed within seconds, although occasional delays can occur during system maintenance or at busy times.

Are there any fees for sending money?

No. The demonstration version does not charge any fees. In a live service, some transfer types, particularly IBFT transfers above a certain amount, can carry a small fee charged by the bank or wallet provider. Any such fee would be shown on the confirmation screen before you approve the transfer.

Can I cancel a transfer after I have sent it?

No. Once a transfer is confirmed it cannot be cancelled or reversed from within the app, which is how real instant payments work. Always check the recipient's number and the amount before pressing "Confirm Transfer". If you sent money to the wrong person in a live service, you would need to contact the recipient or your provider's helpline to request a return.

I pressed Confirm Transfer but nothing happened. Why?

If a field is empty or the amount is not a positive number, the form stays open and a red message asks you to fill in every field with a valid amount. Check that you entered a recipient and an amount. If the fields are correct and you see "Request could not be completed", the server rejected the request; reload the page and try again. If the button shows "Transmitting..." for a long time, your connection to the server may have dropped.

Can I save recipients for next time?

Not yet. The Send Money form does not currently store a list of saved recipients, so you need to type the number each time. You can find previous recipients by looking at the "Transfer to ..." entries in your Payment History. Saved beneficiaries are a planned improvement.

Can I send money abroad, for example to Saudi Arabia?

No. Send Money supports only domestic destinations in Pakistan: JazzCash, Easypaisa and Pakistani bank accounts through IBFT. International remittances involve currency conversion and additional regulatory checks, and are not part of the current version. Travel bookings in Saudi Arabia are paid in PKR through the marketplace instead.

Paying Bills

How do I pay a utility bill?

Press "Bills" in the Services row. Choose the service provider from the list, enter the consumer number printed on your bill, type the amount in PKR and press "Pay Bill". When the payment is recorded, the form closes and an entry such as "KESC Bill - 0400012345678" appears in your Payment History with the category "Bills", and your balance goes down by the amount paid.

Which bill providers are supported?

The Bills form currently supports four providers: KESC (electricity, now known as K-Electric, serving Karachi), SNGPL (Sui Northern Gas Pipelines Limited, natural gas in Punjab and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa), WASA (Water and Sanitation Agency, water supply) and PTCL (Pakistan Telecommunication Company Limited, landline and internet). Other providers, such as the regional electricity companies LESCO, IESCO and MEPCO or SSGC for gas in Sindh and Balochistan, are not yet listed.

Where do I find my consumer number?

Your consumer number, sometimes called a reference number, customer ID or account ID, is printed on your paper or electronic bill, usually near the top beside your name and address. For K-Electric it is the account number; for SNGPL it is the consumer number; for PTCL it is your phone number or account ID. Type it exactly as shown. In a live service the app would fetch the bill amount automatically from the consumer number; in the demonstration version you type the amount yourself.

How much should I enter as the amount?

Enter the amount due shown on your bill. If you are paying before the due date, use the "payable within due date" amount; if you are paying late, use the "payable after due date" amount, which normally includes a late payment surcharge. The demonstration version does not check the amount against the provider, so make sure you type it correctly.

When should I pay my bills to avoid late fees?

Pay before the due date printed on the bill. Pakistani utilities usually add a late payment surcharge after the due date, and repeated non-payment can lead to disconnection. A good habit, which the Money Helper may also suggest, is to pay all your utility bills together during the first week after they arrive so that none are missed. In a live service, payments made near the deadline can take a few hours to show at the utility company.

Will I get a receipt for my bill payment?

In the demonstration version, the record of your payment is the entry in your Payment History, which shows the provider, the consumer number, the date and the amount. A live service would also generate a downloadable receipt with a transaction ID that you could show to the utility company if there were ever a dispute.

Can I pay a bill for someone else?

Yes. A bill is identified only by the consumer number, so you can pay a bill for a parent, relative or neighbour by entering their consumer number. This can itself be a form of charity: paying the utility bill of a family in difficulty is a practical way of helping. Double-check the consumer number before paying, as payments to the wrong number cannot easily be reversed.

Can I set up automatic bill payments?

Not in the current version. Each bill must be paid manually through the Bills form. Scheduled and recurring payments are a possible future feature.

I paid the wrong amount or the wrong consumer number. What can I do?

In the demonstration version no real payment is made, so there is nothing to recover; you can add a manual "Income" entry for the same amount if you want your ledger to reflect the correction. In a live service, contact the utility company with the transaction details: overpayments are normally carried forward as a credit on your next bill, and payments to the wrong consumer number may be traced and refunded.

Mobile Load (Top-up)

How do I top up a mobile number?

Press "Mobile Load" in the Services row. Choose the network operator, enter the 11-digit mobile number starting with 03, type the top-up amount in PKR and press "Purchase Bundle". The top-up is recorded immediately, your balance goes down, and an entry such as "Jazz Load - 03001234567" appears in your Payment History with the category "Mobile Load".

Which mobile networks are supported?

You can top up numbers on all four major Pakistani mobile networks: Jazz, Telenor, Zong and Ufone. Make sure you choose the operator the number actually belongs to. Because of mobile number portability, a number's prefix does not always show its current network, so if in doubt ask the person which network they use.

Can I top up someone else's number?

Yes. Enter any valid mobile number on any supported network. Sending mobile load to family members, students or workers who need to stay in touch is a simple and appreciated way to help.

What is the minimum and maximum top-up amount?

In the demonstration version, any amount greater than zero is accepted. Real operators set their own limits; typically the minimum top-up is around PKR 100 and there are maximum limits per transaction and per day. Note that government taxes are usually deducted from mobile top-ups in Pakistan, so the credit that arrives on the phone can be lower than the amount paid.

Does "Purchase Bundle" buy a data or minutes package?

In the current version, "Purchase Bundle" sends the amount as balance (load) to the number. It does not subscribe the number to a specific internet, call or SMS package. After receiving the load, the phone's owner can subscribe to a bundle of their choice through the operator's own app or dialling code.

The top-up did not arrive on the phone. Why?

In the demonstration version no real top-up is sent, so nothing will arrive on the phone; only the entry in your Payment History is created. In a live service, check that the number and operator were correct, then wait a few minutes, since top-ups are sometimes delayed. If it still has not arrived, contact support with the date, number and amount.

Adding Cash and Manual Entries

What does "Add Cash" do?

"Add Cash" opens a form to append an entry to your ledger by hand. Enter a short description in "Descriptor" (for example "Local Grocery" or "Gift from family"), the amount in PKR in "Volume", choose a category in "Classification" and press "Append to Ledger". This is useful for keeping track of cash income and spending that did not go through the app, so that your balance, chart and the Money Helper's advice reflect your real situation.

How do I record income versus spending?

Choose "Income" as the classification to record money coming in: the amount is added to your balance. Choose any other classification (General, Shopping, Food or Bills) to record spending: the amount is subtracted from your balance. Always type the amount as a positive number; the app works out the direction from the category you choose.

Does Add Cash put real money into my account?

No. Add Cash records an entry in your ledger only. It does not take money from a card or bank account and does not create real funds. In a live service, adding real money would be done through a deposit from a bank account or a wallet, with its own confirmation screen.

Which categories can I choose for a manual entry?

The Classification list offers five categories: General, Shopping, Food, Bills and Income. Use General for anything that does not fit the others. Choosing an accurate category makes your Payment History easier to scan and helps the Money Helper notice patterns, such as a high share of spending on food.

Quick Loan (ReadyCash)

What is Quick Loan (ReadyCash)?

Quick Loan, also called ReadyCash, is a demonstration of an instant small credit facility. Pressing "Quick Loan" in the Services row shows your pre-approved limit and a short description of the terms. Pressing "Disburse Now" adds the full limit to your balance immediately, and a "ReadyCash Credit Line" entry with the category "Loan" appears in your Payment History.

How much can I borrow?

The pre-approved limit shown in the app is PKR 15,000, and pressing "Disburse Now" disburses the whole amount at once. You cannot currently choose a smaller amount. Each time you press the button, another PKR 15,000 is added, because the demonstration does not track outstanding loans.

What are the repayment terms?

The Quick Loan screen states that repayment terms of 15 to 30 days apply with standard markup. In the demonstration version this is descriptive text only: no repayment date is tracked, no markup is calculated, and nothing is ever deducted from your balance. A live credit product would show you the exact repayment date, the total amount to repay and any charges, and would ask you to accept the terms, before any money was disbursed.

Is Quick Loan compliant with Islamic finance principles?

Islamic finance prohibits riba (interest), so a loan that charges a fixed percentage on the amount borrowed is generally considered impermissible. The phrase "standard markup" in the app is descriptive text in a demonstration; no markup is charged. Shariah-compliant alternatives include Qard al-Hasan (a benevolent loan repaid without any increase), and sale-based structures such as Murabaha, where a bank buys an item and sells it at a disclosed profit. If you are considering any real credit product, ask the provider which structure it uses and consult a qualified scholar.

Does taking a Quick Loan affect my credit score?

No. The credit score of 785 shown in the dashboard summary is a fixed demonstration value and does not change when you take a Quick Loan. In real life, borrowing and repaying on time can affect your credit record with the State Bank of Pakistan's credit information bureau and with private credit bureaus.

When should I use a Quick Loan?

A short-term loan is best kept for genuine, temporary emergencies, such as an urgent medical expense a few days before payday, and only when you are confident you can repay it on time. It is not a good way to fund regular spending. Before borrowing, consider whether you can delay the expense, use savings, or ask family for an interest-free Qard al-Hasan. The Money Helper may also suggest using ReadyCash wisely.

Travel: Hotels, Flights and Trip Deals

How do I book travel in WaqfApp?

Press "Travel" in the Services row to open the travel marketplace, which is focused on Lahore. At the top you can switch between three tabs: Hotels (five hotels in Lahore), Flights (five flights departing from Lahore) and Trip deals (two packages from Lahore). Press a hotel or a flight to open its booking panel, where you choose the details, see the total, and either add it to your Waqf Portfolio or book it straight away. Every booking asks you to confirm the amount first and is then recorded as a "Travel" transaction in your Payment History.

Which hotels are available?

The Hotels tab lists five hotels in Lahore, each with its area, its room and its rate per night: Pearl Continental Lahore on The Mall (Deluxe King, breakfast for two, PKR 52,000), Avari Lahore on The Mall (Superior Room, breakfast included, PKR 45,000), The Nishat Hotel in Johar Town (Executive King, breakfast included, PKR 48,000), Faletti's Hotel on Egerton Road (Heritage Room, breakfast included, PKR 36,000) and Ramada by Wyndham Lahore in Gulberg II (Deluxe Room, breakfast included, PKR 26,000).

How do I book a hotel?

On the Hotels tab, press the hotel you want. Its booking panel opens: choose your check-in date, set the number of nights with the minus and plus buttons, and read the total, which is the rate per night multiplied by the nights (for example PKR 45,000 × 2 = PKR 90,000). Press "Reserve" and confirm. A "Stay at Avari Lahore, 2 nights from ..." entry then appears in your Payment History and your balance goes down by the total. To decide later, press "Add to portfolio" instead.

Can I choose my check-in date and number of nights?

Yes. The booking panel has a check-in date, which starts at tomorrow and cannot be set before today, and a nights selector from 1 to 14 nights. The total updates as you change the nights. The server checks the date and the number of nights again before it records the booking, so a past date or more than 14 nights is refused.

Which flights are available?

The Flights tab lists five flights from Lahore (LHE), all nonstop and in Economy: AirSial to Karachi (KHI) on 14 November, 07:00 to 08:50, PKR 22,900; PIA to Quetta (UET) on 16 November, 10:30 to 12:10, PKR 27,500; Emirates to Dubai (DXB) on 19 November, 04:15 to 06:35, PKR 78,500; Saudia to Jeddah (JED) on 21 November, 03:10 to 06:45, PKR 135,000; and Turkish Airlines to Istanbul (IST) on 24 November, 06:40 to 11:30, PKR 168,000. Fares are per passenger, one way.

Why do the arrival times for Dubai, Jeddah and Istanbul look short?

Departure and arrival times are local times at each airport. Dubai is one hour behind Pakistan, and Jeddah and Istanbul are two hours behind, so a flight leaves Lahore at 03:10 and lands in Jeddah at 06:45 local time after 5 hours 35 minutes in the air. The flight duration shown on each row is the real time in the air.

How do I book a flight?

On the Flights tab, press the flight you want. Its booking panel opens: set the number of passengers from 1 to 6 and read the total, which is the fare per passenger multiplied by the passengers. Press "Book", check the confirmation, which names the airline, the route, the date, the passengers and the amount, and confirm. A "Flight LHE to JED, Saudia, 2 passengers" entry then appears in your Payment History.

What baggage is included with each flight?

Each flight row shows its baggage allowance: 20 kg on AirSial to Karachi and PIA to Quetta, 30 kg on Emirates to Dubai and Turkish Airlines to Istanbul, and two pieces of 23 kg on Saudia to Jeddah. Allowances are set by each airline and can change, so check the airline's own conditions before a real journey, particularly on Umrah routes, where many travellers bring Zamzam water home.

Will I receive an e-ticket?

Not in the demonstration version: no booking is made with the airline, so no e-ticket or booking reference (PNR) is issued. Do not travel on the basis of a booking made in this version. In a live service, the airline's e-ticket and booking reference would be sent to your email and shown in the app.

What are Trip deals?

Trip deals are complete travel packages that start from Lahore. Two are available: "Umrah Luxury Plus", 15 days in Makkah and Madina with return flights from Lahore, for PKR 350,000; and "Jeddah Business Hub", 5 days in a five-star hotel with return flights from Lahore, for PKR 210,000. Press "Book" on a deal and confirm to record it as a single "Travel" transaction for the package price.

Does the Umrah package include the visa?

The package description mentions only the destinations, duration and flights. It does not state that a visa, transport between cities, meals or ziyarat (visits to historic sites) are included, so you should not assume they are. Umrah travellers need a valid passport and a Saudi visa that permits Umrah, and a Nusuk permit is required for certain visits such as the Rawdah in Madina. Check current Saudi requirements with an authorised Umrah operator before travelling.

Can I cancel or change a travel booking?

Not within the app. In the demonstration version, bookings cannot be cancelled or changed once confirmed, and there is no refund flow. If you booked by mistake, you can add a manual "Income" entry for the same amount through Add Cash to balance your ledger. Live bookings would follow the cancellation policy of the hotel or airline.

What is the Tickets button for?

The Tickets button in the Services row is a shortcut: it opens Travel directly on the Flights tab, so you can book a flight from Lahore in one step. The Travel button opens the same screen on the Hotels tab.

Are the hotel rates and fares real prices?

They are realistic sample prices for the demonstration, set in Pakistani Rupees. Real hotel rates change with the season, the day of the week and availability, and airfares change with demand and how early you book. In a live service, the price shown would come from the hotel or airline at the moment you book.

What is the best time to book Umrah travel?

Prices and crowds are highest during Ramadan, particularly the last ten nights, and in the school holidays. If you have flexibility, travelling outside these periods is usually cheaper and less crowded. Booking flights several weeks ahead generally gives better fares. The Money Helper may also suggest saving towards a planned trip by setting aside a fixed amount each month.

Ordering Food

How do I order food?

Press "Order Food" in the Services row. You will see five popular restaurants in Lahore as photo cards, each with its cuisine, area, delivery time, delivery fee and minimum order. Press a restaurant to open its menu, add dishes with the "Add" button (a small photo flies into your basket to show it was added), and adjust quantities with the minus and plus buttons. Your basket, beside the menu (or behind the "View basket" bar on a phone), shows the subtotal, the delivery fee and the total. When the minimum order is reached, press "Place order" to place it.

Which restaurants are available?

Five Lahore restaurants are listed: Butt Karahi at Lakshmi Chowk (karahi and desi food, 35 to 45 minutes, delivery fee PKR 149, minimum order PKR 1,000); Haveli Restaurant on Fort Road Food Street (Mughlai and desi, 40 to 50 minutes, PKR 199, minimum PKR 1,500); Bundu Khan at Liberty Market, Gulberg (BBQ, 30 to 40 minutes, PKR 129, minimum PKR 800); Cosa Nostra on M.M. Alam Road, Gulberg (pizza and Italian, 30 to 40 minutes, PKR 199, minimum PKR 1,500); and Johnny & Jugnu in DHA (burgers and wraps, 25 to 35 minutes, PKR 99, minimum PKR 600).

What is on the menus?

Each menu is organised in sections that you can jump between with the tabs at the top. Butt Karahi has chicken, mutton and white karahi in half and full sizes, daal mash, naan, kulcha, lassi and kheer. Haveli Restaurant has mutton nihari, chicken handi, paya, seekh kabab, chicken tikka and a mixed grill, with garlic naan, gulab jamun and kulfi falooda. Bundu Khan has chicken tikka, boti, Bihari kabab, reshmi kabab and mutton chops. Cosa Nostra has pizzas, pasta, garlic bread and tiramisu. Johnny & Jugnu has burgers, wraps, fries and wings.

How much does a food order cost?

The total is the price of every dish in your basket multiplied by its quantity, plus the restaurant's delivery fee. For example, one Daal Mash (PKR 750) and two half Chicken Karahis (PKR 1,850 each) from Butt Karahi come to a subtotal of PKR 4,450, plus the PKR 149 delivery fee, for a total of PKR 4,599. The basket shows each line, the subtotal, the delivery fee and the total before you order.

Why can't I place my order yet?

Each restaurant has a minimum order, and the "Place order" button stays disabled until the subtotal of your dishes reaches it. Under the totals, a bar shows how close you are, and a line tells you exactly how much more to add, for example "Add PKR 250 more to place this order". The delivery fee does not count towards the minimum. Once the subtotal reaches it, the line reads "Minimum order reached".

What do the photos on the restaurant and hotel cards show?

Each card has a cover photo with a short caption that says what it shows: a dish typical of the restaurant's cuisine (such as nihari for Haveli Restaurant), the area or a landmark near each hotel (such as The Mall for Pearl Continental), and each flight's destination (such as the Jeddah Corniche). They are openly licensed photographs from Wikimedia Commons and other open collections, not the venues' own photos; open "Photo credits" at the end of each list to see who took each one and under which licence.

What is the magnifying circle over the photos?

On a computer, moving the pointer over a cover photo shows a round lens that follows the pointer and magnifies the part of the photo under it, so you can look at a dish or a view more closely. It appears only with a mouse or trackpad, and it is switched off when your device is set to reduce motion.

Can I search for a dish?

Yes. The search box above the restaurant list finds restaurants by name, cuisine or area, and also searches every menu: type "nihari", "pizza" or "kheer" and you will see which restaurants serve it, with the matching dishes listed under the restaurant's name. Press the restaurant to open its menu.

Can I order from two restaurants at once?

No. Like most delivery apps, a basket holds dishes from one restaurant, because each order is delivered by that restaurant. If you add a dish from a different restaurant, the app asks whether to start a new basket; confirming clears the old basket and starts a new one with the dish you added.

Is my basket kept if I close the food screen?

Yes. Your basket stays while the app is open, so you can close the food screen, check your balance and come back to finish your order. It is cleared when you place the order, when you start a basket at another restaurant, or when you reload the page.

What does the delivery time mean?

The delivery time on each restaurant, for example "35–45 min" for Butt Karahi, is the restaurant's typical time from order to delivery. In the demonstration version no food is actually prepared or delivered, so the time is for information only.

Can I add special instructions to my order?

Not yet. Special instructions (such as "less spicy" or "no onions"), dish options and delivery addresses are not part of the current version. The menu, quantities and the total are.

Is the food halal?

All the listed restaurants operate in Lahore, where food served in mainstream restaurants is generally halal. WaqfApp does not independently certify restaurants. If halal certification matters to you, check with the restaurant or look for certification from a recognised authority such as the Punjab Halal Development Agency.

Are the menus and prices the restaurants' real menus?

No. The restaurants are well-known Lahore names, but the menus, prices, delivery fees and times in the demonstration are realistic samples, not the restaurants' official menus. A live service would load each restaurant's own menu and prices from the restaurant or the delivery partner.

Your Waqf Portfolio (Cart)

What is the Waqf Portfolio?

The Waqf Portfolio is WaqfApp's cart for travel. When you are planning a trip, you can add hotels and flights to your Portfolio instead of booking each one straight away, then review them together and pay for everything in one step. Open it with the cart icon at the top of the dashboard.

How do I add items to my Portfolio?

In Travel, press a hotel or a flight card: it grows into its booking panel, where you choose the check-in date and nights or the number of passengers and press "Add to portfolio". Press the close button or Escape to shrink the panel back into the list. A notification confirms it. Adding the same hotel with the same check-in date, or the same flight, again increases its nights or passengers instead of creating a duplicate. Trip deals and food orders are booked directly and cannot be added to the Portfolio.

How do I change or remove items?

Each item in the Portfolio shows its name, its check-in date for a hotel, its rate multiplied by its quantity, and its line total. The tabs at the top (All, Hotels and Flights) show every item or only one kind, with how many of each you have. Use the minus and plus buttons to change a hotel's nights (1 to 14) or a flight's passengers (1 to 6), and press "Remove" to take an item out.

What is the Portfolio total?

The total is the sum of every item's rate multiplied by its quantity. For example, two Saudia seats to Jeddah at PKR 135,000 and two nights at Avari Lahore at PKR 45,000 come to PKR 270,000 + PKR 90,000 = PKR 360,000. It updates as soon as you change a quantity or remove an item.

How do I pay for everything in my Portfolio?

Press "Pay for everything" at the bottom of the Portfolio. Every item is booked at once: a "Travel" transaction is created for each item, your balance goes down by the total, the Portfolio is emptied and a notification confirms it.

Is my Portfolio saved if I close the app?

Yes, for as long as the server keeps running. The Portfolio is stored on the server rather than in your browser, so you can close the page, open it again later and find the same items. It is cleared when you pay for it or when the server restarts. Because the demonstration account is shared, other people using the same copy of the app share the same Portfolio.

Why is it called a "Waqf" Portfolio?

The name reflects the app's aim of bringing intention to spending: thinking of purchases, particularly journeys such as Umrah, as part of a considered plan rather than impulse buys. Planning trips together, comparing their total cost against your balance, and paying for them in one step helps you budget, which leaves more room for giving.

Waqf, Sadaqah and Islamic Giving

Is the religious guidance in this FAQ a fatwa?

No. This section explains common Islamic concepts in general terms to help you understand the ideas behind WaqfApp. It is not a religious ruling (fatwa) and does not replace the advice of a qualified scholar. Schools of Islamic jurisprudence differ on many details, such as the minimum threshold for Zakat or how a Waqf may be managed. For any decision that matters to you, particularly regarding Zakat, inheritance, loans or establishing a Waqf, please consult a trusted scholar or a recognised Shariah advisory body.

What is a Waqf?

A Waqf is a charitable endowment in Islamic law. The founder (the waqif) permanently dedicates an asset, such as land, a building, a well, books or a fund of money, so that the asset itself is preserved while its benefit or income is used for a charitable purpose that the founder specifies, such as feeding the poor, funding a school or maintaining a mosque. The asset can no longer be sold, gifted or inherited. A manager, called the mutawalli or nazir, looks after the Waqf according to the founder's conditions. The word is written ■■■ in Arabic and Urdu (■■■■■, al-waqf, in Arabic with the article).

What is the origin of the Waqf tradition?

The best-known foundation is a narration in the collections of al-Bukhari and Muslim. Umar ibn al-Khattab acquired valuable land at Khaybar and asked the Prophet Muhammad, peace be upon him, what to do with it. The Prophet advised him that he could keep the land itself and give its produce in charity. Umar did so, on the condition that the land would not be sold, gifted or inherited and that its yield would go to the poor, relatives, travellers and other good causes. This became the model for awqaf throughout Islamic history.

What is Sadaqah Jariyah?

Sadaqah Jariyah means "continuous charity": giving whose benefit continues after the act of giving, and even after the giver's death. A well-known narration in Sahih Muslim states that when a person dies their deeds come to an end except for three: a continuing charity, knowledge from which benefit is derived, and a righteous child who prays for them. The WaqfApp home screen shows this hadith. In Urdu it is written ■■■■ ■■■■■ and in Arabic ■■■■ ■■■■■. Examples of Sadaqah Jariyah include building a well, planting a tree, endowing a school, distributing copies of the Quran, or contributing to a Waqf.

What is the verse shown on the WaqfApp home screen?

The home screen shows a summary of the meaning of Surah Al-Baqarah, verse 261, which compares spending in the way of Allah to a single grain that grows seven ears, each bearing a hundred grains, and says that Allah multiplies the reward for whom He wills. The app phrases it simply: helping others is like planting a seed that grows into many more. The verse is often quoted to encourage generous and sincere giving.

What is the difference between Zakat and Sadaqah?

Zakat is an obligatory annual payment, one of the five pillars of Islam, due from a Muslim whose wealth is above a minimum threshold (nisab) and has been held for a full lunar year. It is calculated at a fixed rate on eligible wealth and may be given only to the categories of recipients named in the Quran (Surah At-Tawbah, verse 60). In Urdu these are ■■■■■ and ■■■■, and in Arabic ■■■■■■ and ■■■■■■. Sadaqah is voluntary charity: it can be given at any time, in any amount, to anyone in need, and can include non-monetary kindness such as a smile or helping someone carry their load.

How is Zakat usually calculated?

In broad terms, Zakat is 2.5 percent of qualifying wealth held for one lunar year above the nisab. Qualifying wealth typically includes cash, bank balances, gold and silver, business stock and certain investments, minus some immediate debts. The nisab is commonly set at the value of 87.48 grams of gold or 612.36 grams of silver; many scholars recommend using the silver value because it is lower and so benefits more of the poor. Exact rules vary between schools of thought, so use a reliable Zakat calculator or ask a scholar.

Does WaqfApp calculate or pay my Zakat?

Not in the current version. WaqfApp does not calculate Zakat and does not have a feature for paying Zakat to a charity. The dashboard figures, such as the balance and the investment value, are demonstration data and should not be used for a Zakat calculation. In Pakistan, Zakat may also be deducted automatically by banks on the first day of Ramadan from certain savings accounts unless you have submitted a declaration of exemption; check with your bank.

Who is eligible to receive Zakat?

Surah At-Tawbah, verse 60, names eight categories: the poor (fuqara), the needy (masakin), those employed to collect and administer Zakat, those whose hearts are to be reconciled, freeing captives, those in debt, in the way of Allah, and the wayfarer (a traveller in need). Most scholars hold that Zakat cannot be given to one's own parents, grandparents, children or spouse, because supporting them is already one's duty, though other relatives in need are often considered among the most deserving recipients.

Can I give charity through WaqfApp?

The current version focuses on the everyday wallet features and does not yet include a donation feature that sends money to registered charities. You can, however, use the app's existing features in charitable ways: paying a utility bill for a family in difficulty, topping up a student's phone, sending money to a relative in need, or arranging travel for someone performing Umrah. A dedicated donations and Waqf contribution feature is part of the app's purpose and is planned for future versions.

How can a digital wallet support Sadaqah Jariyah?

A digital wallet makes it easy to give small amounts regularly, which the Prophet, peace be upon him, praised: the most beloved deeds to Allah are those done consistently, even if they are small. A wallet can help by reminding you to give, by allowing recurring contributions to an endowment fund, by keeping a record of your giving for Zakat and budgeting, and by making it simple to support projects with lasting benefit such as wells, schools and clinics.

Can a Waqf be made with cash rather than land?

Yes, according to many contemporary scholars and historical practice, particularly in the Ottoman era. In a cash Waqf, the endowed money is preserved and invested in Shariah-compliant ways, and the profits are spent on the charitable purpose. Modern cash Waqf funds and Waqf-based investment certificates operate on this principle. Some classical scholars held reservations about endowing cash because it can be consumed, so it is worth asking how any particular cash Waqf scheme preserves the capital.

Who manages a Waqf?

A Waqf is managed by a mutawalli (trustee or administrator) appointed by the founder or, if none is appointed, by a court or the relevant authority. The mutawalli must look after the endowed asset, collect its income and spend it according to the founder's conditions, and is accountable for doing so. In Pakistan, provincial Auqaf departments administer many endowed properties, such as shrines and mosques, under provincial Waqf laws.

Can I make a Waqf for my family?

Yes. Islamic law recognises both a charitable Waqf (waqf khayri), dedicated to public good, and a family Waqf (waqf ahli or dhurri), whose benefit goes first to the founder's descendants and eventually to a charitable purpose when the family line ends. The legal treatment of family Waqfs varies between countries, so if you are thinking of creating one, seek advice from both a scholar and a lawyer in your jurisdiction.

What is riba and why does it matter for financial apps?

Riba is usually translated as interest or usury: a predetermined increase over the principal of a loan, or certain unequal exchanges of the same type of goods. The Quran prohibits riba strongly (for example Surah Al-Baqarah, verses 275 to 279), and Islamic finance is designed to avoid it. For a financial app this matters for loans, savings accounts and investments: a Shariah-conscious user will want to know whether returns or charges are based on interest or on permitted structures such as profit-sharing, leasing or trade.

What Shariah-compliant alternatives to interest-based loans exist?

Common alternatives include Qard al-Hasan, a benevolent loan repaid without any increase; Murabaha, in which a financier buys an item and sells it to you at a disclosed mark-up, payable in instalments; Ijarah, a lease; Musharakah and Diminishing Musharakah, partnership arrangements often used for home finance; and Mudarabah, in which one party provides capital and the other expertise and profits are shared. Pakistan has a substantial Islamic banking sector regulated by the State Bank of Pakistan that offers these products.

Is it permissible to use a digital wallet at all?

Using a digital wallet to hold money and make payments is generally considered permissible, much like holding cash or using a current account, provided that the wallet is not used for prohibited transactions and that you are not earning interest on the balance. Questions sometimes arise about wallets that pay interest-like rewards on balances or that promote interest-based credit; if this concerns you, choose products that are Shariah-compliant and ask a scholar.

What does "Bismillah" at the top of the app mean?

"Bismillah ir-Rahman ir-Rahim" means "In the name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful". Muslims say it before beginning actions to seek blessing and to remember that their work should be done for good purposes. It opens every chapter of the Quran except one. WaqfApp displays it at the top of the home screen as a reminder that managing money is also a matter of trust (amanah) and intention.

Why does WaqfApp emphasise intention in spending?

In Islamic teaching, actions are judged by their intentions, as in the famous hadith that opens Sahih al-Bukhari. Wealth is seen as a trust from Allah, and a Muslim is accountable for how it is earned and spent. Avoiding waste (israf), spending on one's family, which is itself rewarded, and setting aside a share for others are all encouraged. WaqfApp's design, from the Money Helper to the Portfolio, aims to make spending more deliberate so that giving becomes easier.

How much of my income should I give in charity?

Beyond the obligatory Zakat, there is no fixed amount for voluntary charity. The Quran encourages spending "what is beyond your needs" (Surah Al-Baqarah, verse 219), and scholars advise not giving so much that you neglect your own dependants. Many people find it helpful to commit to a fixed small percentage of every payment they receive, or a fixed monthly amount, so that giving is consistent. Even small, regular amounts can achieve a great deal over time.

Is it better to give charity openly or secretly?

Both are praised. The Quran says that giving charity openly is good, but giving it secretly to the poor is better for you (Surah Al-Baqarah, verse 271). Giving openly can encourage others to give, while giving secretly protects sincerity and the dignity of the recipient. Many people give obligatory Zakat openly through organised channels and voluntary Sadaqah privately.

How can I make sure my charity reaches people who need it?

Give through registered, transparent organisations that publish accounts and report on their projects, or directly to people you know to be in need. In Pakistan, check that a charity is registered with the relevant authority and, for tax purposes, approved under the income tax rules for donations. Be cautious about appeals that pressure you to give immediately, that cannot explain how funds are used, or that ask for payment to personal accounts.

The Money Helper (Smart Advisor)

What is the Money Helper?

The Money Helper, shown on the dashboard as the "Money Flow Assistant", gives you a short, practical suggestion about your money based on your recent activity. It looks at your balance and your transactions, works out where most of your money is going, and suggests one specific action, for example consolidating your utility payments early in the month, keeping Quick Loans for emergencies, or setting aside a fixed amount for a planned trip. Press "Refresh Advice" to get a new suggestion.

How does the Money Helper decide what to suggest?

When you press "Refresh Advice", the app's advisor agent runs three steps on the server. First it analyses your transactions: total income, total spending, and spending by category, such as Bills, Food, Travel or Loan. Then it retrieves the most relevant guidance from this FAQ for your largest spending category or for any warning sign, such as a recent Quick Loan or a balance that has fallen below zero. Finally it writes a suggestion of no more than two sentences that names the category and the amounts involved.

Is the Money Helper's advice professional financial advice?

No. The Money Helper gives general, automated suggestions to help you reflect on your spending. It is not personalised professional financial, investment, tax or religious advice, and it does not know about your circumstances beyond the transactions in the app. For important decisions such as borrowing, investing or calculating Zakat, speak to a qualified adviser or scholar.

Why does the Money Helper say "Advisor report pending"?

"Advisor report pending" means that no suggestion has been generated yet in this session. Press "Refresh Advice" to run the advisor. If it still does not show a suggestion, the server may be busy loading its knowledge base for the first time; wait a few seconds and try again.

What do the thumbs up and thumbs down buttons do?

After a suggestion appears, you can press thumbs up if it was useful or thumbs down if it was not. Your choice is highlighted, and it is reset each time you refresh the advice. In the current version the rating is shown on screen only; in future it can be used to improve which guidance the advisor chooses.

Does the Money Helper send my data to an AI company?

No. The Money Helper runs entirely on the WaqfApp server. Your transactions are analysed by the app's own code, and the guidance comes from this FAQ. No API key is used and nothing is sent to an external AI service. If the person running the server has installed an optional local language model, that model also runs on the same machine.

The Help Center Assistant

What is the WaqfApp Assistant?

The WaqfApp Assistant is the chat assistant in the Help Center, which you can open from the footer of the dashboard. Type a question about the app, such as "How do I pay my gas bill?" or "What is Sadaqah Jariyah?", and press Enter or the arrow button. The assistant searches this FAQ for the most relevant answers and replies within a few seconds, telling you which FAQ entries it used.

How does the assistant find its answers?

The assistant is a retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) agent built with LangChain and LangGraph. Every question and answer in this FAQ is stored as a separate entry in a searchable index. When you ask something, the agent first uses the earlier conversation to interpret short follow-up questions, then retrieves the entries whose meaning and keywords are closest to your question, checks that they are actually relevant, and finally composes a reply from them. If nothing relevant is found, it says so honestly instead of guessing.

Does the assistant need an API key or an internet connection?

No API key is needed. The assistant uses a small embedding model that runs on the server to understand the meaning of questions. The first time the server starts, it downloads this model once from Hugging Face and stores it locally; after that it can work without an internet connection. If the model cannot be loaded, the assistant automatically switches to keyword search, so it keeps working.

Can I ask the assistant questions in Urdu or Arabic?

Yes. The embedding model is multilingual, so questions written in Urdu or Arabic are matched with the relevant English FAQ entries. By default the reply quotes the FAQ in English. If the server is running an optional local language model, the assistant writes its reply in the language you have selected in the app.

Why does the assistant say it could not find an answer?

The assistant answers only from this FAQ, and it will not make up an answer when none of the FAQ entries is relevant enough to your question. Try rephrasing with the name of the feature you are asking about, for example "Quick Loan limit" instead of "how much can I get". If your question is about something the FAQ does not cover, leave a review through the Feedback button so the team can add it.

What are the sources listed under an answer?

Under each reply the assistant lists the FAQ questions it used, with the section each one belongs to. This lets you see where the answer came from and read the full entry in this document if you want more detail. Listing sources is an important feature of retrieval-based assistants, because it makes answers easy to check.

Does the assistant remember our conversation?

Within a single Help Center session, yes: the assistant uses your recent messages to understand follow-up questions such as "and how long does it take?". The conversation is kept in your browser while the page is open and is sent to the server with each question. It is not stored on the server, and it is cleared when you reload the page.

Can the assistant make payments or change my account?

No. The assistant can only answer questions. It cannot send money, pay bills, book travel or change any settings. If the assistant explains how to do something, you still carry out the action yourself using the app's buttons, so nothing happens without your direct action.

What is the difference between the assistant and the Money Helper?

The Help Center assistant answers questions you ask about the app, its features and the ideas behind it, using this FAQ. The Money Helper looks at your own transactions and gives you one suggestion about your spending without you having to ask. Both are built with the same LangChain and LangGraph framework and run on the app's own server.

Can the assistant use a full language model for more natural replies?

Yes, optionally. If the person running the server installs Ollama and sets the OLLAMA_MODEL setting (for example to llama3.2:3b), the assistant passes the retrieved FAQ entries to that local model, which writes a natural reply based only on them, in your selected language. If the model is not available or fails, the assistant falls back to quoting the FAQ directly, so it always gives an answer.

The Private Safe (Vault)

What is the Private Safe?

The Private Safe, labelled "Vault" in some places, is a demonstration of encrypted storage for sensitive notes such as emergency backup keys or important account references. When you open it, the contents are shown as an encrypted stream. Pressing the unlock control shows a sample decrypted note; pressing it again locks the Safe and hides the contents.

Is the Private Safe really encrypted?

Not in the current version. The Private Safe shows how encrypted storage would look and behave, but the sample note is fixed text built into the app, the short delay when unlocking simulates decryption, and nothing you type is stored. Do not keep real passwords, PINs or recovery codes in the app. A live version would encrypt notes on your device with a key that only you hold, so that even the server could not read them.

Where should I keep my real passwords and recovery codes?

Use a reputable password manager that encrypts your data with a master password only you know, and keep important recovery codes on paper in a safe place at home. Never share passwords, PINs or one-time codes with anyone, including people claiming to be from WaqfApp, a bank or a mobile wallet; genuine staff will never ask for them.

Security and Privacy

How does WaqfApp protect my information?

In the current demonstration version there is no personal information to protect: there is no registration, and the only account is the shared demonstration account. Every request is protected by a signed session token that expires after 24 hours. The app's assistants run on the server and do not send your questions or transactions to external AI services. The Privacy Policy, available from the footer, summarises the app's approach to protecting data.

Can someone change the price of an order or a booking?

No. When you order food or book travel, the app sends only what you chose: the dishes and quantities, the hotel, check-in date and nights, or the flight and passengers. The server looks up every price in its own menu and rate data, checks the quantities, the dates and the restaurant's minimum order, and works out the amount itself. Amounts you type, such as a bill or a transfer, must be above zero, and Quick Loan always disburses its fixed limit.

Is my data shared with anyone?

No. WaqfApp does not share data with advertisers or other third parties. In the demonstration version, data exists only in the server's memory and disappears when the server restarts. The only external download the server makes is the one-time download of the assistant's embedding model from Hugging Face, and your questions are not part of that download.

Can other people see what I do in the app?

Yes, in the demonstration version, because everyone using the same copy of the app shares the demonstration account. Anyone using that copy can see the same balance, transactions, Portfolio and reviews. Do not enter anything private, such as your real phone number, consumer numbers or account numbers, unless you are running your own copy of the app.

Is it safe to enter my real bill or phone numbers?

It is best not to. The demonstration version does not send them anywhere, but they are stored in the shared ledger and visible to other users of the same copy until the server restarts. Use made-up example numbers, such as those in the form placeholders, when you are trying out the app.

How do I recognise phishing or scams?

Be suspicious of messages that create urgency ("your account will be blocked today"), ask for passwords, PINs or one-time codes, contain links to websites with slightly misspelled names, or promise prizes and refunds you did not expect. WaqfApp will never ask for your password or PIN. If in doubt, do not click links in the message; open the app directly, or contact the organisation using contact details you already trust.

What should I do if I think my account has been misused?

In the demonstration version no real money can be lost, so there is no risk to your finances. In any live financial app, you should immediately change your password, contact the provider's official helpline to block the account, review recent transactions, and report fraudulent mobile wallet or bank activity to the provider. In Pakistan, cybercrime can be reported to the National Cyber Crime Investigation Agency.

Does WaqfApp use cookies or track me?

The app stores a few small values in your browser's local storage: your session token, so that the server recognises your session, and your theme preference. It does not use advertising cookies or third-party trackers. You can clear these values at any time by clearing your browser's site data; the app will simply start a new session.

Why was the login and registration screen removed?

The login, registration, verification and two-factor screens were removed so that the app opens directly to the dashboard. This makes the demonstration simpler to use and removes the need to create or remember passwords. It also removed a security risk: the earlier version contained a built-in administrator password in its source code, which has been deleted.

Language, Theme and Display

How do I change the language?

Use the EN, UR and AR buttons at the top of the dashboard. EN switches the app to English, UR to Urdu and AR to Arabic. The highlighted button shows the language that is currently active. The change takes effect immediately; you do not need to reload the page.

Why does the layout flip when I choose Urdu or Arabic?

Urdu and Arabic are written from right to left, so WaqfApp switches the whole layout to right-to-left when you select either language. Menus, text and buttons are mirrored so that they read in the natural order for those languages. Switching back to English restores the left-to-right layout.

Does the app remember my language choice?

Not yet. The language returns to English each time the page is loaded. Your theme choice, by contrast, is remembered by your browser. Remembering the language is a planned improvement.

Why are some words still in English after I change language?

The app's own labels and guidance texts are translated, but some content comes from data that has not been translated: hotel, restaurant and airline names, flight routes, transaction descriptions, the FAQ answers quoted by the assistant, and some labels in the service forms. Proper names such as "Pearl Continental" are normally left in their original form in any case.

How do I switch between light and dark mode?

Use the three theme buttons at the top of the dashboard: the monitor icon selects System, the sun icon selects Light and the moon icon selects Dark. The highlighted button shows the active theme. Dark is the default the first time you open the app.

What does the System theme option do?

System makes WaqfApp follow your device's own appearance setting: if your phone or computer is set to dark mode, the app is dark; if it is set to light mode, the app is light. The app checks this setting when you choose System. If you later change your device's setting, reselect System or reload the page for the app to follow it.

Is my theme choice saved?

Yes. Your theme choice is saved in your browser's local storage, so the app opens with the same theme next time you visit from the same browser. If you clear your browser's site data or use a different browser or device, the app returns to the default dark theme.

What is the moving 3D background?

The animated background is a three-dimensional scene drawn with Three.js, a graphics library for the web. It reacts to the selected theme and gives the app its distinctive look. It does not affect any of the app's functions. On older or low-powered devices, the 3D background can make the app feel slower; closing other browser tabs or using a newer browser can help.

Can I turn off the animations?

WaqfApp follows your device's own setting. When "reduce motion" is switched on (in Windows under Accessibility, Visual effects, Animation effects; on an iPhone under Accessibility, Motion; on Android under Accessibility, Remove animations), the photo lens, the cards rising into place, the photo that flies into the basket and the counting totals are all switched off, and the app shows each result straight away.

Can I use WaqfApp on my phone?

Yes. WaqfApp works in mobile browsers. On smaller screens, the left-hand sidebar is hidden to make room for the content, and the dashboard sections stack vertically so that you can scroll through them. For the best experience, use an up-to-date version of Chrome, Safari or Edge.

Is WaqfApp accessible for people with visual impairments?

WaqfApp supports a high-contrast dark theme and a light theme, and uses large controls for the main services. Some areas still need improvement for screen readers, for example icon-only buttons such as the cart, feedback and theme buttons do not yet have descriptive labels, and some text is very small. You can use your browser's zoom (Ctrl and + on a computer, or pinch to zoom on a phone) to enlarge the interface. Accessibility feedback is very welcome through the Feedback button.

Feedback and Reviews

How do I leave feedback about WaqfApp?

Press the speech-bubble icon at the top of the dashboard to open the Feedback window. Choose a rating from one to five stars, write your comments in the text box ("Share your thoughts on our services...") and press "Submit Review". Your review then appears in the "Community Voices" list below the form.

Can I edit my review after submitting it?

Yes. In the Community Voices list, press the edit button beside your review. The form above is filled with your earlier rating and text; make your changes and press "Update Review". To abandon your changes, press "Cancel Edit".

Who can see my review?

Everyone using the same copy of WaqfApp can see all reviews in the Community Voices list, together with the username of the account that wrote them. Because the demonstration account is shared, all reviews appear under the demonstration account's username. Do not include personal information in a review.

Can I delete a review?

Not in the current version. Reviews can be edited but not deleted from within the app. In the demonstration version, all reviews are cleared when the server restarts. If you want to withdraw a review, you can edit it to remove its content.

Does the team read the feedback?

Yes. Feedback is the main way the WaqfApp team learns which features to add next and which parts of the app are confusing. Suggestions for new features, questions that the Help Center assistant could not answer, and reports of problems are all especially useful.

Where can I get help if the FAQ does not answer my question?

Start with the Help Center assistant, which searches this FAQ for you. If it cannot help, leave a review describing your question through the Feedback button. Developers can also open an issue on the project's GitHub repository.

Troubleshooting

The app shows only a dark screen. What should I do?

A dark screen usually means the app is still loading or could not start your session. Wait up to half a minute: the first load after the server starts can be slow while the app is prepared. Then reload the page. If the screen remains dark, check that the server is running and that you are using the correct address, and try a different browser to rule out a browser extension blocking scripts.

Why is the first load so slow?

When the server starts in development mode, the app's code is prepared the first time a browser requests it, and the Help Center assistant builds its search index from this FAQ in the background. On the very first start, the assistant's embedding model is also downloaded once. These steps happen only once per start-up; later page loads are much faster.

A form says "Please fill in every field with a valid amount". What is wrong?

This message appears when a required field is empty or the amount is not a positive number. Check that you entered the recipient, consumer number, mobile number or description, as appropriate, and that the amount is greater than zero and contains only digits (and optionally a decimal point). Remove commas and currency symbols from the amount.

I see "Request could not be completed". What does this mean?

The server received your request but refused it, for example because your session token had expired or the server was restarted while the page was open. Reload the page to start a fresh session and try again. If the message keeps appearing, the server may have encountered an error; the server's console log will show the details.

I see "System interruption". What does this mean?

"System interruption" means that your browser could not reach the server at all, usually because the server has stopped or your network connection has dropped. Check your connection and that the server is still running, then reload the page.

My transactions disappeared. Where did they go?

In the demonstration version, all data, including transactions, reviews and your Portfolio, is held in the server's memory. When the server restarts, everything returns to its starting state: the demonstration balance and sample transactions come back and anything created since is lost. This is expected behaviour for a demonstration and not a fault.

The balance chart shows a strange line. Why?

The first three points of the chart (January to March) are fixed sample values, while the last point is your current balance. If you have made large payments or taken several Quick Loans, the final point can be far above or below the earlier ones, making the line look steep. This is expected.

The Help Center assistant says it is still loading. What should I do?

When the server starts, the assistant builds its index of this FAQ, which can take from a few seconds to a minute on slower computers, and longer on the very first start while the embedding model downloads. Wait a moment and ask again. If the message persists, check the server's console for errors.

The assistant's replies are in English even though I chose Urdu. Why?

By default, the assistant quotes the FAQ, which is written in English. It understands Urdu and Arabic questions, but it does not translate the answers itself. Replies in Urdu or Arabic require the optional local language model to be installed on the server.

The 3D background makes my device slow or hot. Can I turn it off?

There is no setting to turn the 3D background off in the current version. To reduce the load, close other tabs and applications, make sure your browser is up to date, and enable hardware acceleration in your browser's settings. Light mode does not reduce the load.

The page looks broken or the layout is overlapping. What can I do?

Reload the page with a hard refresh (Ctrl+Shift+R on Windows, Cmd+Shift+R on a Mac) to make sure you have the latest version. Check that your browser is up to date; WaqfApp needs a modern browser. If you have zoomed the page, reset the zoom with Ctrl+0. If the problem continues, describe it in a review, including your device and browser.

The QR scanner does not open my camera. Is it broken?

No. The QR scanner screen in the current version is a preview: it shows the scanning frame but does not activate the camera or read codes. Press "Terminate Scanner" to close it.

The Send Money, Bills or Mobile Load form ignores what I typed. Why?

This was a bug in an earlier version, in which those forms submitted fixed example values instead of your entries. It has been fixed: the forms now submit exactly what you type and select. If you still see the old behaviour, do a hard refresh to load the latest version of the app.

Flight bookings or the Portfolio's pay button did nothing. Why?

These were bugs in an earlier version: flight bookings were sent to a server route that did not exist, and the Portfolio's settlement button had no action. Both now work: flights are booked from the Flights tab after you confirm, and the Portfolio's "Pay for everything" button books every item and empties it. Do a hard refresh if you still see the old behaviour.

The Tickets, Savings, Add Money or sidebar buttons did nothing. Why?

These were buttons without an action in an earlier version. Tickets now opens Travel on the Flights tab, Savings shows your monthly savings breakdown, Add Money on the balance card opens Add Cash, and the sidebar icons go to Home, Travel, Order Food, your Payment history and the Help Center.

How do I report a bug?

Use the Feedback button to describe what you were doing, what you expected to happen and what actually happened, together with your device and browser. Developers can open an issue on the project's GitHub repository with the same information and, ideally, any error messages from the browser console or the server log.

For Developers: Running WaqfApp

What do I need to run WaqfApp on my own computer?

You need Node.js version 18 or later (version 22 is recommended), npm, and Git to clone the repository. About 1 GB of free disk space is enough for the dependencies and the assistant's embedding model, and 4 GB of RAM is comfortable. Python 3 with the reportlab package is needed only if you want to rebuild the PDF version of this FAQ. No API keys are required.

How do I install and start the app?

Clone the repository, change into its folder, run "npm install" to install the dependencies, and then run "npm run dev". The server starts on port 3000 by default and prints "[Waqf Server] Running on http://localhost:3000". Open that address in your browser. The first start takes longer because the app is prepared and the embedding model is downloaded.

How do I run the server on a different port?

Set the PORT environment variable before starting the server. In a POSIX shell, run "PORT=3001 npm run dev"; in Windows PowerShell, run "$env:PORT=3001; npm run dev". If PORT is not set, the server uses port 3000. This is useful when another program is already using port 3000.

Which environment variables does WaqfApp use?

All variables are optional. PORT sets the server port (default 3000). APP_URL sets the public base URL of the application. JWT_SECRET sets the key used to sign session tokens; set your own long random value in any shared deployment. OLLAMA_MODEL enables an optional local language model for the assistants, and OLLAMA_BASE_URL sets where Ollama is running (default http://localhost:11434). EMBEDDINGS_MODEL chooses a different Hugging Face embedding model for retrieval, and MODELS_CACHE_DIR sets where downloaded models are stored. Copy .env.example to .env to set them.

Does WaqfApp still need a Gemini API key?

No. Earlier versions called the Google Gemini API directly from the browser, which required a GEMINI_API_KEY and exposed that key to anyone who opened the app. Both the Help Center assistant and the Money Helper have been replaced by a retrieval-augmented agent built with LangChain and LangGraph that runs on the WaqfApp server, and the Gemini dependency has been removed.

How is the project organised?

server.ts is the Express server: it holds the in-memory data, defines the REST API and serves the React front end through Vite. The React application lives in src: App.tsx starts the session, components/Dashboard.tsx contains the dashboard and all service screens, and translations.ts holds the English, Urdu and Arabic labels. The Lahore marketplace (restaurants with their menus, hotels, flights and trip deals) is one data file, shared/marketplace.ts, which the server prices every order and booking from; the Food and Travel screens are in src/components/market. The agent lives in server/agent, and the FAQ that the agent reads lives in docs/faq as Markdown files, one per group of sections. scripts/build_faq_pdf.py builds docs/WaqfApp-FAQ.pdf from those files.

Which API endpoints does the server provide?

POST /api/auth/guest starts a session on the demonstration account. With that session token you can call GET /api/dashboard/summary, GET /api/transactions, GET /api/marketplace and GET /api/user/profile; POST /api/transactions/add, /api/transactions/transfer, /api/bills/pay, /api/mobile/load, /api/loans/readycash, /api/bookings/hotel (hotel id, check-in, nights), /api/bookings/flight (flight id, passengers), /api/bookings/package, /api/food/order (restaurant id and dish ids with quantities) and /api/cart/checkout; GET /api/cart and the cart's add, update and remove routes; and the feedback routes. Booking and order routes take ids and quantities only and compute every amount on the server. The agent adds POST /api/agent/chat, POST /api/agent/advisor and GET /api/agent/status.

How does the RAG agent work?

At start-up, server/agent/knowledge.ts reads every Markdown file in docs/faq, splits it into one LangChain Document per question and answer (with the section and question as metadata), embeds the documents with a local Hugging Face model through a LangChain Embeddings class backed by Transformers.js, and stores them in an in-memory LangChain vector store. A BM25 keyword index is built from the same documents. Retrieval is hybrid: each entry's semantic similarity gets a keyword bonus, so that rare names such as Kolachi, SNGPL or Ollama are still matched, and the BM25 index is used on its own if the embedding model cannot load. The support agent is a LangGraph StateGraph with the nodes contextualize, retrieve, grade, generate and fallback.

What does each node of the support graph do?

contextualize recognises a short follow-up question ("and can I cancel it?") and passes the previous user question along as context. retrieve fetches the closest FAQ entries using hybrid scoring, blending the context in at a lower weight so the topic carries over. grade keeps only entries above a relevance threshold, which is slightly lower for Urdu and Arabic questions because cross-language similarity scores are naturally lower. A conditional edge then sends the state to generate when relevant entries remain, or to fallback when none do. generate either asks the optional local language model to answer using only those entries, or composes an extractive answer from the best entry and lists related questions. fallback explains that the FAQ has no answer and suggests what to try.

How does the advisor graph work?

The advisor is a second LangGraph StateGraph with the nodes analyze, retrieve and advise. analyze totals the user's income and spending by category from the server's own transaction data, so the browser cannot tamper with the figures. retrieve searches the FAQ for guidance related to the largest spending category or to warning signs such as a recent Quick Loan or a negative balance. advise produces a two-sentence suggestion, either from rule-based templates that quote the real figures or, when a local model is configured, by asking that model to write the suggestion from the figures and the guidance.

Which embedding model is used and where is it stored?

By default the agent uses Xenova/paraphrase-multilingual-MiniLM-L12-v2, a compact sentence-embedding model that understands more than 50 languages, including Urdu and Arabic. It runs on the CPU through Transformers.js and ONNX Runtime. It is downloaded from Hugging Face (about 135 MB) the first time the server starts and cached in the .cache/waqfapp/models folder in your home directory, so later starts work offline. Set MODELS_CACHE_DIR to use a different folder; on Windows, keep the full path short, because ONNX Runtime cannot open model files on paths longer than 260 characters. Set EMBEDDINGS_MODEL to use a different model, such as the smaller English-only Xenova/all-MiniLM-L6-v2.

How do I enable a local language model with Ollama?

Install Ollama from ollama.com, pull a model such as "ollama pull llama3.2:3b", make sure Ollama is running, and start WaqfApp with OLLAMA_MODEL set to the model name. The agent then uses LangChain's ChatOllama for the generate and advise steps, grounded only in the retrieved FAQ entries. Smaller models need less memory; on a computer with 8 GB of RAM, models of around 1 to 3 billion parameters are a sensible choice. If Ollama is unreachable, the agent falls back to extractive answers.

How do I add or change FAQ entries?

Edit the Markdown files in docs/faq. Each "#" heading starts a section and each "##" heading is a question; the text under a question, up to the next heading, is its answer. Restart the server so the agent rebuilds its index; there is no separate training step, which is one of the main advantages of retrieval-augmented generation. Run "npm run faq:pdf" to rebuild the PDF document.

How do I check whether the agent is ready?

Call GET /api/agent/status. It reports whether the index is ready, how many FAQ entries were indexed, which retrieval mode is active (embeddings or keyword fallback), and whether a local language model is configured. The first request to the chat or advisor endpoints also waits for the index to finish building, so no question is lost while it loads.

Why is all data lost when the server restarts?

The server keeps users, transactions, carts and reviews in JavaScript arrays in memory, which suits a demonstration but is not durable. To make data persist, replace those arrays with a database such as PostgreSQL or SQLite. The agent's vector index is rebuilt from the FAQ files at each start, so it does not need to be persisted, although for a much larger knowledge base you could switch the in-memory store to a persistent vector database.

Is the current version ready for production use with real money?

No. It has no real accounts, no persistent storage and no payment provider integration. Before handling real money you would need proper user accounts with secure authentication, a database, integration with licensed payment partners, server-side validation of every amount, rate limiting, audit logs, and a security review. You would also need to set a strong JWT_SECRET instead of the built-in default.

How do I build the app for production?

Run "npm run build" to build the front end into the dist folder, then start the server with NODE_ENV set to production, which makes it serve the built files instead of running Vite in development mode. The build warns that the main JavaScript bundle is larger than 500 kB, mainly because of the 3D graphics and chart libraries; splitting the code with dynamic imports would reduce the initial download.

How do I run the type checker?

Run "npm run lint", which runs the TypeScript compiler in check-only mode across the project. It should finish without errors. Running it before every commit catches mistakes such as misspelled properties or wrong argument types early.

How can I contribute to WaqfApp?

Fork the repository on GitHub, create a branch for your change, make the change with a clear commit message, check that "npm run lint" and "npm run build" succeed, and open a pull request explaining what the change does and why. Useful contributions include translations, accessibility improvements, new FAQ entries, persistent storage and real charity integrations.

Budgeting and Money Habits

How can WaqfApp help me budget?

WaqfApp shows your balance, a chart of how it changes, and a categorised history of everything you spend, so you can see where your money goes. Recording cash spending with Add Cash makes the picture complete. The Money Helper then points out your largest spending category and suggests one action at a time. A simple routine is to look at your Payment History once a week, compare it with what you planned, and adjust the following week.

What is a simple budgeting method I can follow?

A widely used starting point is to divide your take-home income into three parts: about half for needs (rent, utilities, food, transport, school fees), up to a third for wants (eating out, shopping, entertainment), and at least a fifth for saving and giving. Many Muslim families adapt this by setting aside their giving first, as soon as income arrives, so that charity is a priority rather than whatever is left over. Adjust the proportions to your circumstances; the important thing is to decide them in advance.

How do I reduce spending on bills?

Pay all your bills together in the first week after they arrive so you never pay late-payment surcharges, which can be significant on Pakistani utility bills. Check each bill for errors such as estimated meter readings. Reduce electricity use during peak hours, when tariffs are higher, switch off appliances on standby, and use energy-efficient lights and fans. For gas, check for leaks and use lids when cooking. Review your internet package to make sure you are not paying for more speed than you use.

How do I reduce spending on food?

Food often becomes the largest flexible expense. Plan the week's meals, buy staples such as flour, rice, lentils and oil in larger quantities when prices are good, and cook at home more often. Treat food delivery as an occasional treat rather than a habit: a single delivery order costs as much as several home-cooked meals. In WaqfApp you can see the effect in your Payment History by looking at the entries with the Food category.

How should I save for Umrah or another big trip?

Decide the total you need, including flights, hotels, visa, local transport, food and gifts, and the date you plan to travel. Divide the total by the number of months remaining to get a monthly saving target, and set that amount aside as soon as your income arrives. Compare packages with separate flight and hotel bookings, and travel outside Ramadan and school holidays if you can, when prices are usually much lower. The Waqf Portfolio lets you add hotels and flights to see their combined cost before you commit.

How large should my emergency fund be?

A common guideline is to keep three to six months of essential expenses in an easily accessible savings account or wallet that you do not use for everyday spending. Start with a smaller goal, such as one month's expenses, and build up from there. An emergency fund means you can cope with sudden costs, such as a medical bill or a broken appliance, without needing a loan.

When is borrowing a reasonable choice?

Borrowing can be reasonable for a genuine emergency or for something that increases your long-term wellbeing, such as education, when you have a realistic plan to repay. It is rarely a good idea for everyday spending or for things you could save for. Before borrowing, ask yourself whether the need is urgent, whether you can repay from your next income without hardship, and whether an interest-free option such as a Qard al-Hasan from family is available.

How can I make giving a regular habit?

Choose a fixed amount or a fixed percentage of every income you receive, and give it as soon as the income arrives. Pick one or two causes you care about, for example a local school, a clinic or a water project, so that your giving builds up into something lasting. Small regular amounts are easier to sustain than occasional large ones, and the hadith teaches that the most beloved deeds are those done consistently, even if small.

What warning signs in my spending should I watch for?

Watch for a balance that falls lower each month even though your income has not changed; regular use of short-term loans; late-payment surcharges on bills; spending in one flexible category, such as food or shopping, that grows month after month; and many small payments that you cannot remember making. The Money Helper highlights some of these signs, such as a recent Quick Loan or a negative balance.

How often should I review my finances?

A quick weekly look at your Payment History takes only a few minutes and helps you notice problems early. Once a month, compare your total income and spending, check that all bills were paid on time, and move any surplus into savings or giving. Once a year, review your larger goals, such as saving for travel or education, and calculate whether Zakat is due on your savings.

Glossary of Terms

What does PKR mean?

PKR is the international currency code for the Pakistani Rupee, the currency of Pakistan. All balances, prices and transactions in WaqfApp are shown in PKR. One rupee is divided into one hundred paisa, although paisa are rarely used in everyday prices.

What does SAR mean?

SAR is the currency code for the Saudi Riyal, the currency of Saudi Arabia. WaqfApp lists flights from Lahore to Jeddah and Umrah trip deals but shows their prices in PKR. Travellers to Saudi Arabia will need riyals, or a card that can be used there, for spending during their trip.

What is IBFT?

IBFT stands for Inter Bank Funds Transfer, a service through which customers of one Pakistani bank can send money instantly to an account at another bank, using the recipient's account number or IBAN. "Bank Account (IBFT)" is one of the destinations in WaqfApp's Send Money form.

What is an IBAN?

An IBAN (International Bank Account Number) is a standard format for identifying a bank account. In Pakistan, IBANs have 24 characters: the letters PK, two check digits, a four-letter bank code and a 16-digit account number. Using an IBAN reduces the chance of sending money to the wrong account.

What are JazzCash and Easypaisa?

JazzCash and Easypaisa are the two largest mobile wallet services in Pakistan, operated in association with Jazz and Telenor respectively. They let people send and receive money, pay bills and top up phones using a mobile number as the account identifier. Both are available as destinations in WaqfApp's Send Money form.

What is a consumer number?

A consumer number is the unique reference that a utility company gives to each customer connection, printed on every bill. You need it to pay a bill through WaqfApp's Bills form. Different companies call it by different names, such as account number, reference number or customer ID.

What is mobile load?

Mobile load, or top-up, is prepaid credit added to a mobile phone number so that it can be used for calls, SMS and internet. In WaqfApp, you can send load to numbers on Jazz, Telenor, Zong and Ufone through the Mobile Load service.

What is a ledger?

A ledger is a complete, ordered record of financial transactions. WaqfApp's Payment History is your ledger: every payment, transfer, booking, loan and manual entry is added to it as a new line, and entries are never edited or deleted. Your balance is calculated from your opening balance and all the entries in the ledger.

What is a session token?

A session token is a long, signed string that the WaqfApp server gives your browser when your session starts. The browser sends it with every request so that the server knows which account the request belongs to. WaqfApp's tokens are JSON Web Tokens (JWTs) that expire after 24 hours.

What is end-to-end encryption?

End-to-end encryption (E2EE) means that data is encrypted on the sender's device and can only be decrypted on the intended recipient's device, so that no one in between, not even the service provider, can read it. WaqfApp's Private Safe demonstrates the idea; in the current version it does not yet perform real encryption.

What is RAG?

RAG stands for retrieval-augmented generation. Instead of relying only on what a language model memorised during training, a RAG system first retrieves relevant passages from a trusted knowledge base, in WaqfApp's case this FAQ, and then uses those passages to produce the answer. This makes answers more accurate, easier to check through their sources, and easy to update by editing the knowledge base.

What are LangChain and LangGraph?

LangChain is an open-source framework for building applications with language models; it provides standard building blocks such as document loaders, embeddings, vector stores, retrievers and chat model interfaces. LangGraph, from the same team, is a library for building agents as graphs of steps (nodes) connected by edges, with shared state and conditional branching. WaqfApp's assistants use LangChain's building blocks and organise them into LangGraph graphs.

What is an embedding?

An embedding is a list of numbers that represents the meaning of a piece of text, produced by an embedding model. Texts with similar meanings have embeddings that are close together, which lets a computer find FAQ entries that mean the same as your question even if they use different words. WaqfApp computes embeddings on its own server.

What is a vector store?

A vector store is a database that holds embeddings and can quickly find the ones closest to a given query embedding. WaqfApp uses LangChain's in-memory vector store, which is rebuilt from the FAQ each time the server starts.

What is BM25?

BM25 is a classic keyword-based ranking method used by search engines. It scores documents by how often they contain the words in your query, giving more weight to rare words and less to very common ones. WaqfApp's assistant uses BM25 as a fallback if its embedding model cannot be loaded.

What is Ollama?

Ollama is free software that downloads and runs open language models, such as Llama, Qwen or Gemma, on your own computer, with no cloud service or API key. WaqfApp can optionally use a model running in Ollama to write more natural answers from the retrieved FAQ entries.

What is Qard al-Hasan?

Qard al-Hasan, literally "a goodly loan", is an interest-free loan given out of kindness, repaid at the original amount with no increase. The Quran praises lending to Allah a goodly loan. It is often offered by families, mosques and some Islamic microfinance institutions to people in need.

What is Murabaha?

Murabaha is an Islamic finance contract of sale at a disclosed cost plus profit. The financier buys an asset and sells it to the customer at an agreed higher price, which the customer usually pays in instalments. Because it is a sale rather than a loan, the profit is permissible in the view of most scholars, provided the conditions of the contract are met.

What is a mutawalli?

A mutawalli is the trustee or manager of a Waqf, responsible for preserving the endowed asset, collecting its income and spending it according to the founder's conditions. A mutawalli acts as a trustee and is accountable for the Waqf's proper management.

What is nisab?

Nisab is the minimum amount of wealth a Muslim must own, held for a lunar year, before Zakat becomes obligatory. It is traditionally defined as 87.48 grams of gold or 612.36 grams of silver, and its value in rupees changes with the price of these metals.

What is Umrah?

Umrah is the lesser pilgrimage to Makkah, which, unlike Hajj, can be performed at any time of year. Its rites include entering the state of ihram, performing tawaf around the Kaaba, walking between Safa and Marwah (sa'i), and shaving or trimming the hair. Many pilgrims also visit Madina to pray at the Prophet's Mosque. WaqfApp's "Umrah Luxury Plus" Trip Deal covers both Makkah and Madina.

Ramadan, Eid and Special Occasions

How can WaqfApp help me plan my finances for Ramadan?

Ramadan usually brings extra spending on suhoor and iftar food, hosting family, charity and Eid preparations, as well as the time many people choose to pay their Zakat. A few weeks before Ramadan, estimate these costs, set aside the amount from your income, and pay your utility bills early so that they do not add pressure during the month. During Ramadan, check your Payment History weekly to keep Food spending in line with your plan, and record cash spending with Add Cash.

Why do many people give more charity in Ramadan?

Ramadan is a month in which good deeds are especially encouraged. Narrations describe the Prophet, peace be upon him, as the most generous of people, and most generous of all in Ramadan. Many Muslims therefore choose to give extra Sadaqah, pay their annual Zakat, sponsor iftar meals for others, or support long-term projects during the month, particularly in the last ten nights, which include Laylat al-Qadr.

What is Fitrana (Zakat al-Fitr)?

Fitrana, also called Zakat al-Fitr or Sadaqat al-Fitr, is a small charitable payment due on behalf of each member of a household, including children, before the Eid al-Fitr prayer. Its purpose is to purify the fast and to make sure that people in need can also celebrate Eid. The amount is based on the value of a set measure of staple food; in Pakistan, religious authorities announce recommended amounts each year according to wheat, barley, dates and raisins. Check the current year's announcement before paying.

When should Fitrana be paid?

Fitrana should be paid before the Eid al-Fitr prayer so that it reaches recipients in time for them to use it for Eid. Many scholars permit paying it during Ramadan, a day or more in advance, which is helpful when giving through organisations that need time to distribute it. Paying it after the Eid prayer without a valid reason is generally discouraged; it then counts as ordinary charity.

How can I budget for Eid gifts and Eidi?

Make a list of everyone you plan to give Eidi or gifts to, decide an amount for each, and add up the total well before Eid. Withdraw or set aside that amount in advance so that you are not tempted to overspend in the busy last days. New banknotes for Eidi are popular in Pakistan, and banks often run special exchange counters before Eid, so plan ahead if you want them.

How do I plan for Qurbani at Eid al-Adha?

Qurbani, the sacrifice of an animal at Eid al-Adha, is a significant expense for many families. Decide early whether you will buy an animal yourself, share in a larger animal such as a cow or camel (which can be shared by up to seven people), or pay an organisation to perform the sacrifice on your behalf, possibly in another region where the meat is needed more. Animal prices in Pakistan typically rise sharply as Eid approaches, so saving monthly and buying or booking earlier usually costs less.

Can I use WaqfApp to send Eidi to relatives far away?

Yes. Use Send Money to send money to a relative's JazzCash or Easypaisa wallet or to their bank account, and Mobile Load to send phone credit. In the demonstration version no real money moves, but in a live service this would be a quick way to include relatives in other cities in your Eid giving. Send a little before Eid to allow for any delays during the holiday rush.

How should I plan for Hajj compared with Umrah?

Hajj takes place only on specific days of the Islamic month of Dhul Hijjah, and in Pakistan places are allocated through the government Hajj scheme and through licensed private operators, with applications usually opening several months in advance. Costs are considerably higher than for Umrah and must normally be paid in full well before departure. WaqfApp's travel marketplace currently offers Umrah-style packages and individual hotels and flights, not Hajj packages.

Is it permissible to borrow money to perform Umrah?

Scholars generally advise that Umrah, being highly recommended but not obligatory in the same way as Hajj for those able, should be performed with money one already has, and that it is better not to take on debt for it, especially interest-based debt. If you are considering borrowing for any religious journey, consult a scholar. Saving steadily towards the trip is the most widely recommended approach.

How can I support others during Ramadan and Eid through the app?

You can pay a utility bill for a family facing hardship, send money to a relative or neighbour in need, top up the phone of a student away from home, or book an iftar meal through Order Food for someone who cannot afford it. Each of these is recorded in your Payment History, which helps you keep track of your giving alongside your other spending.

Getting the Most from the Assistant

What kinds of questions can I ask the Help Center assistant?

You can ask about anything covered in this FAQ: how to use each feature, such as sending money, paying bills, booking travel or using the Portfolio; what the app's terms and labels mean; the Islamic concepts behind WaqfApp, such as Waqf, Sadaqah Jariyah, Zakat and Qard al-Hasan; budgeting tips; security and privacy; troubleshooting; and, for developers, how to run and configure the app and its agent.

How should I phrase my questions for the best answers?

Ask one thing at a time and include the name of the feature or topic, for example "How do I pay my SNGPL gas bill?" or "What is the Quick Loan limit?". Short, specific questions find the right entry more reliably than long questions that mix several topics. If an answer is close but not quite what you needed, ask a follow-up such as "and can I cancel it?"; the assistant uses your previous question to understand it.

Can you give some example questions to try?

Try: "How do I send money to Easypaisa?", "Which bill providers are supported?", "What is the minimum order at Butt Karahi?", "How do I book a flight to Jeddah?", "What is Sadaqah Jariyah?", "How is Zakat calculated?", "Is the Private Safe really encrypted?", "Why did my transactions disappear?", "How do I change the language to Urdu?" and "How do I enable a local language model with Ollama?".

Why does the assistant sometimes suggest related questions?

When the assistant quotes an FAQ entry, it also lists other entries that were close matches, so that you can explore nearby topics or find the right answer if the first one was not exactly what you meant. You can copy one of those questions into the chat box to see its full answer.

Can the assistant answer questions about my own transactions?

No. The Help Center assistant answers general questions from this FAQ and does not read your transaction history. For a suggestion based on your own spending, use the Money Helper on the dashboard and press "Refresh Advice", which analyses your transactions on the server.

Will the assistant's answers change over time?

Yes, whenever this FAQ is updated. Because the assistant retrieves its answers from the FAQ files each time the server starts, adding or correcting an entry immediately changes what the assistant says after the next restart, without any retraining. This keeps the assistant's answers consistent with the published FAQ document.